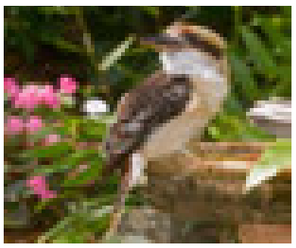


Kangaroo



Koala



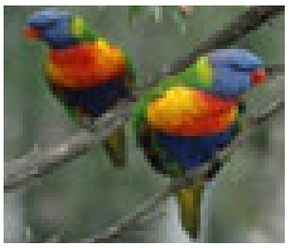
kookaburra



platypus



Bottle tree



Rainbow lorikeet



Emu



Merino sheep

pouches. Kangaroo is the national animal of Australia. Koala, platypus Wallaby and Dingo are the other important animals of Australia. The bird species like the laughing kookaburra, emu, and rainbow lorikeet are the major birds of Australia.



The people who work in the sheep stations in Australia are known as **Jackaroos**. **Aborigines** are the indigenous people of the Australia.

Economic Activities

Agriculture, forestry, fishing, mining, manufacturing, trade and services are the major economic activities of Australia. Wheat is the chief grain crop of Australia. Rice, sugarcane Mediterranean fruit like grapes, oranges and apricots are produced around Perth, Adelaide and Melbourne. Tasmania is known as the **Apple Island**. Rice, tobacco and cotton are grown in the northern parts of Tasmania. Sheep rearing is carried out along with cultivation in the regions of warm climate. Oats, maize and barley are also cultivated to some extent. Australia is well known for Vineyards and Orchards. Cattle rearing is common in the tropical savannas and sheep farming in the temperate grassland. **Merino sheep** are rearing in southern Australia, Tasmania, Victoria and New South Wales. Dairy cattle are reared in farms close to the cities of east and south coast. Among dairy cows Illawarra, Jersey and Ayrshire are the most popular in Australia.

Fishing is also a major economic activity of Australia. Marine fishing is popular in the entire coastal regions of the country. Inland fishing is very limited. Forest resources are also very limited in the country.



The sheep industry is well developed in Australia. The wool is described as the **'Cash Crop'** of Australia.

Mineral Resources

Minerals are the largest export item of Australia. It contributes about 10 percent of country's GDP. Australia is the world's leading producer of bauxite, limonite, rutile and zircon, the second largest producer of gold, lead, lithium, manganese ore and zinc, the third largest producer of iron ore and uranium and the fourth largest producer of black coal .The coal belts of the country stretches from New Castle to Sydney on the south eastern coast. Iron ores are found mainly in southern and Western Australia.

VIII_Std_Geography_Unit 7.indd 149 2/21/2020 10:38:17 AM